



A deck for naming sensory and niche-construction needs. Point at a card, or lay a few. No reading is needed to play.

No scoring

No points, no matching, no right answer, no winning. There is no wrong card and no wrong hand.

The child controls sharing

A spread laid face-down stays private. Turning a card up is the child sharing it. The turn is the consent — you don't turn their cards over for them.

Five ways to play

Show me *early years, anyone*

Pick the one card that's you right now. That's the whole game. Say back what you see: "Buzzy today. Okay." Under a minute.

Build my day *a child and a support worker*

Lay a place, a weather, and a couple of what-helps cards — *cave, buzzy, headphones*. You've been handed a design brief. Build the conditions. Two to five minutes.

Class weather *a whole group*

Everyone lays a weather card face-up. The room's weather becomes visible. No one is named. Nothing is scored. Two minutes.

Map the edges *older kids*

Walk the lily-pad cards across a timetable. Find where the hard transitions actually are. Self-advocacy, in their hands. Ten minutes.

Play as the environment *staff training*

Deal what-helps cards with needs that conflict — room to move against less talking. Build one habitat that holds them all. Feel neurological pluralism instead of hearing about it. Twenty minutes.

When a child lays "stuck"

Stuck is a lily pad — a place to land, not a failure. Read it as information: something in the environment isn't fitting yet. Don't push the child across. Ask what would help them land, or offer a what-helps card and let them choose.

Respond in three moves

1. **Mirror it back.** Name what you see, plainly. No praise, no fixing, no interrogation.
2. **Reach for the environment, not the child.** A card is a request to change the conditions. Change them.
3. **Leave the sharing with the child.** What they turn up is theirs to turn up.

If it's not working, it's not the child.

Broken systems, not broken people. The deck exists so a child can shape the space around them — and so the people beside them can read what they need without being asked to explain in words they may not have.